

# Frames

| Operation                                                                                                                                                  | Keystroke                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Function                                                                                                                                                                   | Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| <b>Emacs Frames</b><br>See <a href="#">Quick intro Emacs Wiki Glossary Emacs Lisp Frames</a>                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Emacs calls frames what modern graphical Operating Systems call “windows”, or more specifically “OS windows”.</li><li>Emacs supports multiple frames, both when Emacs works in graphical mode and in text terminal mode.<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>In terminal mode, only one frame is visible at any given time, the other frames are hidden. The current frame number is shown on the mode line.<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Using multiple frames is a powerful way to keep track of development contexts, with each frame having its own set of <a href="#">ℹ Windows</a> and <a href="#">ℹ Tab Bar</a> .</li></ul></li></ul></li></ul> |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Last updated on:                                                                                                                                           | 2026-09-29                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Open this PDF file.<br>See also: <a href="#">ℹ Help/Info</a>                                                                                               | <b>&lt;f11&gt; F &lt;f1&gt;</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>(pel-help-pdf &amp;optional OPEN-WEB-PAGE)</b>                                                                                                                          | Open the <a href="#">ℹ Frames</a> local PDF. With <b>C-u</b> , <b>M--</b> , <b>M- -1</b> or <b>C- -1</b> prefix: open the remote GitHub hosted PDF instead. If the <b>pel-flip-help-pdf-arg</b> user-option is set it’s the other way around.                                                                                                                                         |
| <a href="#">ℹ Customize PEL frame control</a>                                                                                                              | <b>&lt;f11&gt; F &lt;f2&gt;</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>(pel-customize-pel &amp;optional OTHER-WINDOW)</b>                                                                                                                      | Customize PEL frame management support. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>If OTHER-WINDOW is non-nil (use <b>C-u</b>) , display in other window.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <a href="#">ℹ Customize Emacs frame control</a>                                                                                                            | <b>&lt;f11&gt; F &lt;f3&gt;</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>(pel-customize-library &amp;optional OTHER-WINDOW)</b>                                                                                                                  | Customize Emacs frame management support.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Enter/Exit full screen                                                                                                                                     | <b>&lt;f11&gt; &lt;f11&gt;</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>(pel-toggle-frame-fullscreen)</b>                                                                                                                                       | Toggle frame fullscreen mode on/off in graphics mode.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|                                                                                                                                                            | In Terminal mode, issue error describing how to toggle the fullscreen mode if possible. In macOS Terminal.app and iTerm.app that's <b>⌘-C-f</b><br>⌘ Standard GNU Emacs normally binds <b>&lt;f11&gt;</b> to (toggle-frame-fullscreen). But PEL use <b>&lt;f11&gt;</b> as a prefix key, therefore it rebinds it.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Set Frame Font</b><br>With Emacs running in graphics mode, you can change the font of all windows with the menu-set-font command.                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Change font of current Frame<br>See also: <a href="#">ℹ Faces/Fonts</a>                                                                                    | <b>&lt;f11&gt; F F</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>(menu-set-font)</b>                                                                                                                                                     | Interactively select a font and make it the default on all frames. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Set the default on both the existing and future frames in the current session. It is not persistent, so next time you start Emacs the default font is used.</li></ul>                                                                                                        |
| <b>Move to another graphical frame using cursors</b>                                                                                                       | The following commands move point to another graphical Emacs frame existing in the direction selected by the cursor key.<br> <b>framemove</b>  PEL installs and activates this when the <b>pel-use-framemove</b> user option is set to <b>t</b> . Also available in the <a href="#">Emacs Wiki framemove</a> .<br> These four commands commands only work in <b>graphics mode</b> .                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Move to graphical frame above                                                                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; S-&lt;up&gt;</b></li><li><b>&lt;Esc&gt; S-&lt;up&gt;</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>(fm-up-frame)</b>                                                                                                                                                       | Move point to frame above current frame (if one exists and is located there).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Move to graphical frame below                                                                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; S-&lt;down&gt;</b></li><li><b>&lt;Esc&gt; S-&lt;down&gt;</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>(fm-down-frame)</b>                                                                                                                                                     | Move point to frame below current frame (if one exists and is located there).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Move to graphical frame at right                                                                                                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; S-&lt;right&gt;</b></li><li><b>&lt;Esc&gt; S-&lt;right&gt;</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>(fm-right-frame)</b>                                                                                                                                                    | Move point to frame at right of the current frame (if one exists and is located there).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Move to graphical frame at left                                                                                                                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; S-&lt;left&gt;</b></li><li><b>&lt;Esc&gt; S-&lt;left&gt;</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>(fm-left-frame)</b>                                                                                                                                                     | Move point to frame at left of the current frame (if one exists and is located there).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Manage Frames</b>                                                                                                                                       | Emacs frame operations work in <b>both</b> modes: graphics and text terminal. In graphics mode a new frame is creating a separate OS frame. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>In text terminal mode a new frame is inside the <b>same</b> OS frame: it simply hides the other(s) existing frame(s). The mode line identifies the currently active frame number as “F1”, “F2”, etc... The windows numbers are all part of the space number-space.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Show frame count                                                                                                                                           | <b>&lt;f11&gt; F ?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>(pel-show-frame-count)</b>                                                                                                                                              | Display the number of Emacs active frames in the mini-buffer.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Delete this frame</b><br><br>See <a href="#">ℹ Windows Hydra</a>                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 0</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F 0</b></li><li><b>⌘-w</b></li><li><b>* &lt;f7&gt; w M-F</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>(delete-frame &amp;optional FRAME FORCE)</b>                                                                                                                            | Delete FRAME, permanently eliminating it from use. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>FRAME must be a live frame and defaults to the selected one</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Delete all other frames</b>                                                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 1</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F 1</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>(delete-other-frames &amp;optional FRAME)</b>                                                                                                                           | Delete all frames on FRAME’s terminal, except FRAME.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>New Frame below</b><br><br>See <a href="#">ℹ Windows Hydra</a>                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 2</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F 2</b></li><li><b>⌘-n</b></li><li><b>* &lt;f7&gt; w M-f</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>(make-frame-command)</b></li><li><b>(make-frame &amp;optional PARAMETERS)</b></li></ul>                                           | Make a new frame, on the same terminal as the selected frame.<br> On macOS in graphics mode only: make-frame is called for <b>⌘-n</b> , it has the same effect as make-frame-command.                                                                                                              |
| Display buffer in other (next) frame                                                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 C-o</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F b</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>(display-buffer-other-frame BUFFER)</b>                                                                                                                                 | Display a buffer preferably in another frame.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Tear window in frame<br>See <a href="#">ℹ Windows Hydra</a>                                                                                                | <b>C-x w ^ f</b><br><b>&lt;f11&gt; w i f</b><br><b>* &lt;f7&gt; w F</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>(tear-off-window CLICK)</b>                                                                                                                                             | Delete the selected window, and create a new frame displaying its buffer. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>See: <a href="#">ℹ Windows</a></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Select another frame</b>                                                                                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>In text terminal mode: iterate through all frames, make the next frame visible in the terminal window and update the frame number shown on the mode line.</li><li>In graphics mode: with no/nil argument (the default): iterate through visible frames, with ARG non nil: iterate through all frames (included iconified frames).</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Select next frame</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>the frame with the next higher frame number</li></ul>                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F n</b></li><li><b>⌘-`</b></li><li><b>* &lt;f7&gt; w }</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>(pel-next-frame ARG)</b>                                                                                                                                                | Make next frame visible.<br> The <b>⌘-`</b> key is a macOSs command that moves to the next frame of the same application: no Emacs code is invoked but the effect is the same in graphics mode.                                                                                                    |
| <b>Select previous frame</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>the frame with the next lower frame number</li></ul>                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F p</b></li><li><b>⌘--</b></li><li><b>* &lt;f7&gt; w {</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>(pel-previous-frame ARG)</b></li><li><b>(ns-prev-frame)</b></li></ul>                                                             | Make previous frame visible.<br> The <b>⌘-`</b> key is a macOSs command that moves to the next frame of the same application: no Emacs code is invoked but the effect is the same in graphics mode.                                                                                                |
| <b>Move to other (next) frame</b>                                                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 o</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F o</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>(other-frame ARG)</b>                                                                                                                                                   | Activate the other frame. Numeric argument identifies frame in Z order.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Open in frame                                                                                                                                              | The following commands open a buffer, file or <a href="#">ℹ Dired</a> buffer in a frame.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Switch to buffer in other frame</b>                                                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 b</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F O</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>(switch-to-buffer-other-frame BUFFER-OR-NAME &amp;optional NORECORD)</b></li><li><b>(ido-switch-buffer-other-frame)</b></li></ul> | Switch to buffer BUFFER-OR-NAME in another frame. BUFFER-OR-NAME may be a buffer, a string (a buffer name), or nil. Return the buffer switched to.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Display <a href="#">ℹ Project</a> buffer in another frame.                                                                                                 | <b>C-x 5 p C-o</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>(project-display-buffer-other-frame BUFFER-OR-NAME)</b>                                                                                                                 | Display BUFFER-OR-NAME preferably in another frame. Prompts for a buffer belonging to the current project. Two buffers belong to the same project if their project instances, as reported by ‘project-current’ in each buffer, are identical. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Uses ‘<b>display-buffer-other-frame</b>’ to display selected buffer into another frame.</li></ul> |
| <b>Find file in other (next) frame in read-only.</b>                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 r</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F r</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>(find-file-read-only-other-frame FILENAME &amp;optional WILDCARDS)</b>                                                                                                  | Edit file read-only in other frame with name obtained via minibuffer.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Find file in other (next) frame</b>                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 f</b></li><li><b>C-x 5 C-f</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F f</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>(find-file-other-frame FILENAME &amp;optional WILDCARDS)</b>                                                                                                            | Switch to/open another file and show it in another frame.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Run Dired in other (next) frame.</b> <br>See <a href="#">ℹ Dired</a> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>C-x 5 d</b></li><li><b>&lt;f11&gt; F d</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>(dired-other-frame DIRNAME &amp;optional SWITCHES)</b></li><li><b>(ido-dired-other-frame)</b></li></ul>                           | "Edit" directory DIRNAME. Like ‘dired’ but make a new frame. See <a href="#">ℹ Frames</a><br><br> PEL activates <b>ido</b> when the <b>pel-use-ido-mode</b> user option is set to <b>t</b> .                                                                                                       |
| <b>macOS frame</b>                                                                                                                                         | The following commands are available under macOS for Emacs running in graphical mode only.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Hide Emacs frame                                                                                                                                           | <b>⌘-h</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>(ns-do-hide-emacs)</b>                                                                                                                                                  |  On macOS in graphics mode only: hide Emacs frame. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Retrieve it via the <b>⌘-&lt;tab&gt;</b> key.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                   |
| Hide all other applications                                                                                                                                | <b>⌘-H</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>(ns-do-hide-others)</b>                                                                                                                                                 |  On macOS in graphics mode only: hide all other applications, except Emacs. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Retrieve them via the <b>⌘-&lt;tab&gt;</b> key.</li></ul>                                                                                                                        |
| Iconify frame                                                                                                                                              | <b>⌘-m</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>(iconify-frame &amp;optional FRAME)</b>                                                                                                                                 |  On macOS in graphics mode only: iconify the frame.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

| Operation                                              | Keystroke      | Function                           | Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ⓘ <b>Project aware</b><br>commands in another<br>frame |                |                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>C-x 5 p</b> | (project-other-frame-command)      | Run project command, displaying resultant buffer in another frame.<br>The command is selected by the next key, shown below. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>See ⓘ <b>Project</b> for more information about the specific project commands.</li> </ul> |
|                                                        | <b>C-b</b>     | project-list-buffers               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>!</b>       | project-shell-command              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>&amp;</b>   | project-async-shell-command        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>D</b>       | project-dired                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>F</b>       | project-or-external-find-file      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>G</b>       | project-or-external-find-regexp    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>b</b>       | project-switch-to-buffer           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>c</b>       | project-compile                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>d</b>       | project-find-dir                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>e</b>       | project-eshell                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>f</b>       | project-find-file                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>g</b>       | project-find-regexp                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>k</b>       | project-kill-buffers               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>o</b>       | project-any-command                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>p</b>       | project-switch-project             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>r</b>       | project-query-replace-regexp       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>s</b>       | project-shell                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>v</b>       | project-vc-dir                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>x</b>       | project-execute-extended-command   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                        | <b>C-o</b>     | project-display-buffer-other-frame |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |